

WAR WITH AMALEK

TEXT: Exodus 17:8-16 (NKJV) *"Now Amalek came and fought with Israel in Rephidim. 9 And Moses said to Joshua, "Choose us some men and go out, fight with Amalek. Tomorrow I will stand on the top of the hill with the rod of God in my hand." 10 So Joshua did as Moses said to him, and fought with Amalek. And Moses, Aaron, and Hur went up to the top of the hill. 11 And so it was, when Moses held up his hand, that Israel prevailed; and when he let down his hand, Amalek prevailed. 12 But Moses' hands became heavy; so they took a stone and put it under him, and he sat on it. And Aaron and Hur supported his hands, one on one side, and the other on the other side; and his hands were steady until the going down of the sun. 13 So Joshua defeated Amalek and his people with the edge of the sword. 14 Then the LORD said to Moses, "Write this for a memorial in the book and recount it in the hearing of Joshua, that I will utterly blot out the remembrance of Amalek from under heaven." 15 And Moses built an altar and called its name, The-LORD-IS-MY-BANNER; 16 for he said, "Because the LORD has sworn: the LORD will have war with Amalek from generation to generation."*

INTRO: Amalek was the grandson of Esau. Genesis 36:12 (NKJV) *"Now Timna was the concubine of Eliphaz, Esau's son, and she bore Amalek to Eliphaz. These were the sons of Adah, Esau's wife."*

Let me remind you of the family history behind our story:

- Jacob and Esau were the twin sons of Isaac and Rebekah
- While Rebekah was pregnant a prophesy was delivered to her that within her womb were two nations and the younger would be stronger and rule the older
- Esau was the first born and Jacob was the second born

- When the twins were born Jacob's hand was holding to Esau's heel
- Esau was a rugged man who loved the outdoors, hunting, fishing etc.
- Jacob was a peace loving guy who enjoyed gardening and hunting with a digital camera
- Isaac loved Esau while Rebekah favored Jacob
- Esau sold his birthright to Jacob for a bowl of soup
- Rebekah helped Jacob deceive his father into blessing him with the right hand of blessing

These events set into motion a rivalry that would grow worse and worse as the centuries would come and go.

Amalek was the only group of people that God ever identified as His constant enemy. From the time of Esau to the death of Haman the Amalekites were a thorn in the flesh of God's chosen people. Just about the time things appeared to be going in the right direction and peace was prevailing Amalek would begin to cause problems again.

Following forty plus years of wilderness wandering Moses is restating the Law to Israel when Amalek begins to raise sand once again. Moses instructs Joshua to gather the necessary man power to fight against Amalek. It is here that we discover our Scripture setting for this message.

I. AMALEK IS THE FLESH!

A. Saul was told to completely destroy Amalek but decided to stop short of carrying out the plan of God. (Saved King Agag alive, etc.) Because he failed to carry out the plan of God against Amalek his kingdom was taken from him. If you and I fail to wage war against the flesh until it is completely destroyed, it will sooner or later get the upper hand and destroy God's plans and our plans for our lives. (Woman who raised a Boa Constrictor)

B. While I am fully aware that the descendants of Amalek cannot be found on the earth following the death of Haman in the book of Esther, I am here to tell you that the spirit of Amalek lived longer than the patriarchs, Exodus, and judges; Past the prophets, priests, and kings; the spirit of Amalek lived beyond the disciples, the cross and Pentecost; it is alive in the world right now and is prevalent in this room today!

C. Amalek is the flesh, so what do we do about the flesh?
Declare perpetual war on it!

II. PERPETUAL WAR MUST BE DECLARED ON AMALEK!

A. We live in a time of wars and rumors of wars. America has been at war since 9/11/01, a war against terrorism.

Wars are fought for the following reasons:

- Self-Preservation
- Defense of Allies
- Acts of aggression

B. As near as I can tell the reason God became so angry with Amalek is because of the way they dealt with Israel as they were fleeing slavery, and leaving Egypt. Deuteronomy 25:17-18 (NKJV) *"Remember what Amalek did to you on the way as you were coming out of Egypt,18 "how he met you on the way and attacked your rear ranks, all the stragglers at your rear, when you were tired and weary; and he did not fear God."*

God and Moses formed a holy alliance to defeat Amalek.

C. Romans 7,8,& 9.

III. THE BATTLE PLAN!

A. Exodus 17:8-13 (NKJV) *"Now Amalek came and fought with Israel in Rephidim.9 And Moses said to Joshua, "Choose us some men and go out, fight with Amalek. Tomorrow I will stand on the top of the hill with the rod of God in my hand."10*

So Joshua did as Moses said to him, and fought with Amalek. And Moses, Aaron, and Hur went up to the top of the hill.¹¹ And so it was, when Moses held up his hand, that Israel prevailed; and when he let down his hand, Amalek prevailed.¹² But Moses' hands became heavy; so they took a stone and put it under him, and he sat on it. And Aaron and Hur supported his hands, one on one side, and the other on the other side; and his hands were steady until the going down of the sun.¹³ So Joshua defeated Amalek and his people with the edge of the sword."

B. Here is the plan of Moses:

- Face Amalek with faith - Stand on the top of the hill
- Face Amalek with a full arsenal - Choose men to fight - Amalek doesn't fight fair - Stack the deck against him
- Face Amalek with the banner of God - Stand with the Rod of God
- Fight as a family - Moses and Aaron were brothers and Hur was married to Miriam (Hur was also the son of Caleb - No one is stronger than when they have their family fighting with them - If you don't have family serving the Lord don't worry we will be your family!

C. Don't be found fighting each other - fight Amalek.

CONCLUSION: The solution:

- Properly identify the enemy - Beware of friendly fire
- Attack the enemy using - The name of Jesus, the Word of God, The power of the Holy Spirit
- Be on guard for future attacks - Amalek is not dead he is temporarily defeated
- Amalek is going to finally be completely defeated